

Meridian Labs Employee Policy Handbook

Complete Policy Corpus

Last compiled: September 2026

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Meridian Labs Policy Corpus — Index

This is a small, synthetic (fictional) corpus of company policy documents for **Meridian Labs, Inc.**, a made-up software company. It’s designed to support realistic employee questions for testing a RAG (retrieval-augmented generation) pipeline or similar Q&A system. All names, contacts, email addresses, and figures are fictional and safe to use for development, demos, or evaluation. No real company data is included.

Contents (15 files)

#	File	Format	Topic
00	employee-handbook-overview.md	Markdown	Company overview, values, contacts, handbook structure
01	onboarding-guide.md	Markdown	Pre-day-one, day one, first week, first 90 days

#	File	Format	Topic
02	pto-policy.md	Markdown	PTO accrual, carryover, requesting time off
03	holiday-schedule.md	Markdown	Fixed holidays, floating holidays, winter shutdown
04	remote-work-policy.md	Markdown	Remote/hybrid/in-office categories, stipends, core hours
05	expense-reimbursement-policy.md	Markdown	Travel, meals, mileage, corporate card, non-reimbursables
06	data-security-policy.md	Markdown	MFA, device security, data classification, incident reporting
07	benefits-overview.md	Markdown	Health/dental/vision, 401(k), life/disability, EAP, wellness
08	equipment-policy.md	Markdown	Laptop issuance, replacement cycle, loss/damage, BYOD, returns
09	leave-of-absence-policy.md	Markdown	Parental, medical, bereavement, jury duty, military, voting leave
10	workplace-conduct-code.md	Markdown	Anti-harassment, conflicts of interest, reporting, discipline
11	quick-reference-contacts.html	HTML	One-page contact/escalation cheat sheet
12	new-hire-faq.txt	Plain text	Short Q&A summary of the most common new-hire questions
13	compensation-and-payroll.md	Markdown	Pay schedule, overtime, pay bands, bonuses, equity, referrals

#	File	Format	Topic
14	business-travel-safety.md	Markdown	Trip booking, approval thresholds, travel device security, personal safety

Suggested use

- Load all files as separate documents into your retrieval index (chunk by heading/section for best results — most documents use consistent ## section headers).
- The documents cross-reference each other by name (e.g., the Onboarding Guide references the Benefits Overview), which is intentional and useful for testing multi-hop or cross-document retrieval.
- Realistic test questions this corpus supports include things like: “How much PTO do I accrue after 4 years?”, “What’s the laptop replacement cycle?”, “How do I report a lost company laptop?”, “How many weeks of paid parental leave do non-birthing parents get?”, “What’s the coworking stipend?”, “What happens if I click a phishing test link?”, and “Who do I contact to report harassment?”
- Numeric details (accrual rates, dollar amounts, day counts) are deliberately specific and consistent within a document but vary slightly across related documents (e.g., approval thresholds) to mimic the kind of real-world policy documents that require precise retrieval rather than generic summarization.

License / usage note

All content here was authored for this corpus and is fictional. It is free to use, modify, and redistribute for testing, demo, or educational purposes.

Meridian Labs Employee Handbook — Overview

Document owner: People Operations **Last updated:** March 2026 **Applies to:** All full-time and part-time employees of Meridian Labs, Inc. (US-based)

1. Welcome

Welcome to Meridian Labs. This handbook is the starting point for understanding how we work, what we offer, and what’s expected of everyone on the team. Meridian Labs is a mid-sized software company (around 480 employees) headquartered in Portland, Oregon, with additional hubs in Austin, Texas and Raleigh, North Carolina, and a fully remote workforce spread across 30+ US states.

This handbook is a summary of company policy. Where a specific policy document (linked throughout this handbook and stored in the Policies folder on the company intranet) conflicts with a general statement here, the specific policy document governs.

2. Company mission and values

Meridian Labs builds infrastructure software that helps engineering teams ship reliably. Our stated values, used in hiring, performance reviews, and day-to-day decision-making, are:

- **Default to transparency** — share context broadly unless there’s a specific reason not to.
- **Own the outcome** — see problems through to resolution, not just your piece of them.
- **Assume good intent, verify with data** — disagreements are resolved with evidence, not seniority.
- **Sustainable pace** — we plan for the long run, not constant crunch.

3. Employment classifications

Classification	Description
Full-time	Regularly scheduled for 30+ hours per week
Part-time	Regularly scheduled for fewer than 30 hours per week
Exempt	Not eligible for overtime pay under the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)
Non-exempt	Eligible for overtime pay for hours worked beyond 40 in a workweek
Contractor	Engaged via a separate services agreement; this handbook does not apply

Your offer letter states your classification. If you’re unsure, ask your manager or People Operations ().

4. How the handbook is organized

This handbook links out to standalone policy documents covering:

1. Onboarding
2. Paid time off (PTO)
3. Company holidays
4. Remote and hybrid work
5. Expense reimbursement
6. Data security and acceptable use
7. Benefits
8. Equipment
9. Leave of absence (parental, medical, bereavement, jury duty, military)
10. Workplace conduct and anti-harassment

Each policy document has its own owner and revision history. Policies are reviewed at least annually, and material changes are announced in the #company-announcements Slack channel and via email at least 30 days before taking effect, except where a change is required by law to take effect sooner.

5. Key contacts

Need	Contact
General HR questions	
Payroll	
IT / equipment issues	 or the #it-help Slack channel
Benefits enrollment	
Security incidents	 (monitored 24/7)
Confidential conduct concerns	 or the anonymous ethics line at 1-888-555-0199

6. Handbook acknowledgment

All new employees are required to review this handbook and its linked policies within their first five business days and confirm acknowledgment in the HR system (BambooHR). Acknowledgment does not create an employment contract; employment at Meridian Labs is at-will unless a signed agreement states otherwise.

7. Questions and exceptions

Any policy in this handbook can have exceptions approved in writing by a VP-level manager or above, in consultation with People Operations, except where the policy reflects a legal requirement (e.g., minimum leave entitlements), in which case no exception is possible below the legal minimum.

New Employee Onboarding Guide

Document owner: People Operations **Last updated:** January 2026

1. Before your first day

Once you accept your offer, People Operations will send you:

- A welcome email with your start date, manager's name, and first-day logistics.
- An I-9 and W-4 (or state equivalent) to complete electronically via BambooHR at least 3 business days before your start date.
- A laptop shipping notification (for remote/hybrid employees) — laptops ship 5–7 business days before start date via FedEx with signature required. In-office employees pick up equipment from the front desk on day one.
- A calendar invite for new-hire orientation, held every other Monday at 9:00 AM Pacific.

2. Day one checklist

Time	Activity
9:00 AM	New-hire orientation (company overview, benefits intro, IT setup) — 90 minutes
10:30 AM	Meet your manager for a 1:1 kickoff
11:00 AM	Complete required trainings: Code of Conduct, Data Security Basics, Anti-Harassment (all three must be completed within the first 5 business days)
Afternoon	Meet your onboarding buddy (assigned by your manager before your start date)

You'll receive login credentials for email, Slack, and core tools during orientation. If your laptop hasn't arrived by 9:00 AM on day one, contact immediately.

3. Your onboarding buddy

Every new hire is paired with a buddy — a peer (not your manager) from your team or an adjacent team — for their first 90 days. The buddy's role is to answer “dumb question” style queries, help you find your way around Slack and internal tools, and check in weekly for the first month.

4. First week goals

By the end of week one, you should have:

- Completed all three required compliance trainings.

- Set up two-factor authentication (MFA) on your Meridian Labs Google account (required — see the Data Security Policy).
- Met with your manager to review your 30/60/90-day plan.
- Joined your team’s Slack channels and relevant company-wide channels (#company-announcements, #random, and your department channel at minimum).
- Enrolled in benefits, if eligible (see Section 6 below) — you have 30 days from your start date to enroll before the window closes.

5. First 90 days

Managers are expected to set 30/60/90-day goals with new hires during the first week. People Operations sends a 30-day check-in survey and a 90-day check-in survey automatically; these are used to catch onboarding gaps early, not for performance evaluation.

Your first formal performance conversation happens at the 90-day mark, in addition to regular 1:1s with your manager.

6. Benefits eligibility timing

Health, dental, and vision benefits are effective on the first day of the month following your start date (for example, a March 12 start date means benefits begin April 1). You must actively enroll within 30 days of your start date — coverage does not begin automatically. See the Benefits Overview document for plan details.

401(k) enrollment is available immediately and can be started at any time through the Fidelity NetBenefits portal; there is no waiting period for 401(k) participation, though the employer match vesting schedule described in the Benefits Overview applies.

7. Equipment and accounts

New hires are issued one laptop (MacBook Pro or Dell XPS, employee’s choice, subject to role requirements) and, for in-office or hybrid employees, a monitor and peripherals kit available for pickup or shipment. See the Equipment Policy for replacement cycles and return requirements.

8. Who to ask

Question about	Contact
Paperwork, I-9, benefits enrollment	
Laptop didn’t arrive / IT account issues	
Payroll setup, direct deposit	
Anything else in week one	Your onboarding buddy

Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy

Document owner: People Operations **Last updated:** February 2026 **Applies to:** All regular full-time and part-time US employees. Contractors and interns are not eligible for PTO under this policy.

1. Overview

Meridian Labs provides accrued PTO for vacation, personal time, and routine short-term illness. PTO is separate from company holidays (see the Holiday Schedule) and from the Leave of Absence policy, which covers parental, medical, bereavement, jury duty, and military leave.

2. Accrual rates

PTO accrues per pay period (twice monthly, on the 1st and 16th) based on tenure:

Tenure	Annual accrual	Per pay-period accrual
0-2 years	15 days/year	0.625 days
3-5 years	20 days/year	0.833 days
6+ years	25 days/year	1.042 days

Part-time employees accrue PTO on a pro-rated basis matching their scheduled hours (e.g., an employee scheduled for 20 hours/week accrues at 50% of the full-time rate).

Accrual begins on your first day of employment, but PTO cannot be used until you have completed 30 days of employment, except where local law requires earlier availability.

3. Maximum balance and carryover

- Employees may carry over up to **40 hours (5 days)** of unused PTO into the new calendar year.
- Any balance above the carryover cap is forfeited on December 31, except in states where forfeiture is prohibited by law (currently California and a small number of other states), where PTO instead accrues up to a cap of 1.5x the employee's annual accrual rate and stops accruing until the balance drops below that cap.
- There is no cash-out of unused PTO upon resignation or termination, except in states where payout is legally required (California, among others), in which case unused, accrued PTO is paid out at the employee's final base rate of pay.

4. Requesting PTO

1. Submit a PTO request in BambooHR at least **5 business days** in advance for planned time off, or as soon as reasonably possible for unplanned absences (e.g., sudden illness).

2. Your manager approves or denies the request within 2 business days. Requests are generally approved unless they create a coverage gap on a critical delivery date.
3. Requests for more than 2 consecutive weeks require VP-level approval in addition to manager approval.
4. PTO is tracked in whole or half-day increments; there is no minimum increment smaller than half a day.

5. PTO and company holidays

If a company holiday falls within a period of approved PTO, that day is counted as a holiday, not PTO, and is not deducted from your PTO balance.

6. Sick time within PTO

Meridian Labs does not maintain a separate sick leave bank; short-term illness is covered under the general PTO balance described above. Employees who need extended time off due to a serious health condition should refer to the Leave of Absence Policy, which covers medical leave beyond what PTO reasonably covers.

Some states and cities require separate, legally mandated sick leave with different accrual and usage rules (for example, no advance notice requirement for sick use). Where local law requires a distinct sick leave bank, that local policy addendum — available from People Operations — controls, and complies with or exceeds the applicable jurisdiction's minimum requirements.

7. Unlimited PTO exception

Employees at the Director level and above are on an unlimited (discretionary) PTO plan rather than the accrual model above. Discretionary PTO still requires manager approval following the same notice guidelines, and there is no accrued balance to track, carry over, or pay out upon separation.

8. FAQ

Can I go negative on my PTO balance? Yes, up to -5 days (40 hours), with manager approval, to accommodate reasonable planning around accrual timing. Balances may not go more negative than that.

What happens to my PTO if I transfer between full-time and part-time? Your accrual rate adjusts prospectively as of the effective date of the change; past accrued PTO is not recalculated.

Who do I contact with questions? for policy questions; your manager for approval-related questions.

Company Holiday Schedule

Document owner: People Operations **Last updated:** November 2025 **Applies to:** All US-based employees

1. Observed holidays (2026)

Meridian Labs observes 11 paid holidays per year for all regular full-time and part-time employees (prorated by scheduled hours for part-time staff):

Holiday	2026 Date
New Year's Day	Thursday, January 1
Martin Luther King Jr. Day	Monday, January 19
Presidents' Day	Monday, February 16
Memorial Day	Monday, May 25
Juneteenth	Friday, June 19
Independence Day	Friday, July 3 (observed; July 4 falls on a Saturday)
Labor Day	Monday, September 7
Thanksgiving Day	Thursday, November 26
Day after Thanksgiving	Friday, November 27
Christmas Eve	Thursday, December 24
Christmas Day	Friday, December 25

The company also observes a **winter shutdown** between December 26 and December 31, during which the office is closed and remote employees are not expected to work. Shutdown days are paid but are not counted against PTO or the 11 listed holidays above — they are a separate, additional benefit.

2. Floating holidays

Each employee receives **2 floating holidays** per calendar year, prorated in their first year based on start date (1 floating holiday if hired after July 1). Floating holidays can be used for any purpose, including religious or cultural observances not on the standard list, and are requested the same way as PTO in BambooHR. Floating holidays do not carry over to the next calendar year and are not paid out upon separation.

3. Holiday pay for non-exempt employees

Non-exempt employees who are required to work on an observed holiday receive holiday pay at **1.5x their regular hourly rate** for hours worked that day, in addition to receiving the holiday as paid time off if they were otherwise scheduled. Exempt employees do not receive additional holiday pay, consistent with their salaried status.

4. Holidays falling on a weekend

When a listed holiday falls on a Saturday, it is observed on the preceding Friday. When it falls on a Sunday, it is observed on the following Monday.

5. Regional variations

Employees working in jurisdictions with additional legally mandated holidays (for example, certain state or local holidays) will have those days added to their personal holiday calendar; check with if you believe this applies to you.

6. Questions

Contact for questions about the holiday calendar or floating holiday balances.

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Document owner: People Operations & IT **Last updated:** April 2026

1. Work location categories

Meridian Labs recognizes three work location categories, assigned at time of hire and noted in your offer letter:

- **Remote** — no expectation of regular office attendance. May live anywhere in the US where Meridian Labs is registered to employ (currently all 50 states except Alaska and Hawaii, due to payroll tax registration limits).
- **Hybrid** — expected in an office hub (Portland, Austin, or Raleigh) at least **2 days per week**, typically Tuesday and Thursday, as coordinated with your team.
- **In-office** — expected in the office 4–5 days per week; applies to a small number of roles (e.g., facilities, some hardware lab roles).

Changing categories requires manager and People Operations approval and may affect eligibility for location-based pay adjustments.

2. Core working hours

Regardless of location, all employees are expected to be reachable during **core hours of 10:00 AM–3:00 PM in their local time zone**, Monday through Friday, for meetings and real-time collaboration. Outside core hours, employees may structure their day flexibly, subject to manager expectations and role requirements (e.g., on-call rotations).

3. Home office requirements for remote and hybrid employees

To work remotely, employees must maintain:

- A reliable internet connection with a minimum of 25 Mbps download / 5 Mbps upload.
- A private or semi-private space suitable for video calls involving confidential company or customer information.
- Compliance with the Data Security Policy, including full-disk encryption on the company laptop, a locked screen when away from the device, and no use of public/unsecured Wi-Fi for work without a VPN connection.

4. Home office stipend

Remote and hybrid employees receive a one-time **\$500 home office setup stipend** during their first 60 days, reimbursed through the standard expense process (see Expense Reimbursement Policy) for items such as a desk, chair, or monitor. Additionally, all remote and hybrid employees receive a recurring **\$50/month internet and utilities stipend**, paid via payroll as a taxable stipend rather than expense reimbursement.

5. Working from outside the US

Employees who wish to work temporarily from outside the United States (for example, an extended trip) must submit a request via at least 2 weeks in advance. Approval depends on tax, legal, and data-residency considerations and is capped at **30 calendar days per year** outside the US without a separate international employment arrangement. Working from outside the US without prior approval may create personal tax and immigration exposure for the employee and is not permitted.

6. Coworking stipend

Remote employees who prefer not to work from home may expense up to **\$300/month** for a coworking space membership in lieu of (not in addition to) the \$50/month internet stipend.

7. Meeting and travel expectations

Hybrid and remote teams are expected to gather in person for **quarterly team off-sites** (travel and lodging covered by the company per the Expense Reimbursement Policy) and one **company-wide all-hands event** per year.

8. Equipment for remote work

See the Equipment Policy for laptop issuance, peripherals, and return procedures. Remote employees are responsible for returning company equipment via prepaid shipping label within 10 business days of separation from the company.

9. Questions

Contact your manager for team-specific hybrid schedule coordination, or for policy questions.

Expense Reimbursement Policy

Document owner: Finance **Last updated:** March 2026

1. General principle

Meridian Labs reimburses reasonable, business-related expenses incurred while performing your job. Employees should spend company money as carefully as they would spend their own. All expenses require a valid business purpose and a receipt for any single item over \$25.

2. How to submit expenses

1. Submit expenses through Ramp (our expense management platform) within **30 days** of the expense being incurred. Expenses submitted after 60 days will generally not be reimbursed absent an exception approved by your manager and Finance.
2. Attach a receipt and select the correct expense category and cost center.
3. Your manager approves expenses up to \$1,000; expenses above \$1,000 require both manager and department VP approval.
4. Approved expenses are paid out in the next payroll cycle for card-based purchases requiring reconciliation, or reimbursed via direct deposit within 5–7 business days for out-of-pocket expenses.

3. Reimbursable expense categories

Category	Guideline
Business travel (flights, trains)	Economy class for flights under 6 hours; premium economy permitted for flights over 6 hours
Lodging	Up to \$250/night in standard cities; up to \$350/night in high-cost cities (SF, NYC, Boston, Seattle, DC)
Meals while traveling	Up to \$75/day, itemized, or a \$75/day per diem without receipts
Ground transportation	Taxis, rideshare, and mileage (reimbursed at the current IRS standard mileage rate)
Client and team meals	Up to \$50/person, with attendee names and business purpose noted
Conference and training fees	Pre-approved by manager; budget varies by role and department
Home office equipment	Per the \$500 stipend described in the Remote Work Policy
Software and subscriptions	Must be pre-approved by IT and Finance to ensure security review and avoid duplicate tooling

Category	Guideline
Professional development / books	Up to \$500/year without additional approval

4. Non-reimbursable expenses

The following are never reimbursed, regardless of business context:

- Alcohol at solo meals (alcohol at approved client or team dinners is reimbursable in moderation, subject to manager approval)
- Traffic and parking fines, or other penalties
- Personal entertainment unrelated to a business purpose
- First-class airfare
- Spa services, in-room movies, or minibar charges
- Commuting between home and your regular office (not a business expense)

5. Corporate card

Employees who travel frequently or manage a team budget are issued a Ramp corporate card. Corporate card transactions must still be categorized and receipted within 30 days in the Ramp platform. Personal purchases on the corporate card are not permitted; repeated violations may result in card revocation and, in serious cases, disciplinary action.

6. Mileage

Employees using a personal vehicle for business purposes (not including regular commuting) are reimbursed at the IRS standard mileage rate in effect at the time of travel (67 cents per mile as of 2026). Mileage must be logged with origin, destination, and business purpose.

7. International travel

International business travel requires pre-approval from your manager and VP at least 3 weeks in advance. Per diem rates for meals abroad follow US Department of State foreign per diem rates for the destination city.

8. Audits and misuse

Finance periodically audits expense reports. Falsifying an expense report, submitting personal expenses as business expenses, or splitting a purchase to avoid an approval threshold are treated as policy violations under the Workplace Conduct Code and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

9. Questions

Contact or the #finance-help Slack channel.

Data Security and Acceptable Use Policy

Document owner: Security Team **Last updated:** May 2026 **Applies to:** All employees, contractors, and anyone with access to Meridian Labs systems or data

1. Purpose

This policy establishes minimum security requirements to protect Meridian Labs' systems, customer data, and intellectual property. All employees must complete the "Data Security Basics" training within their first 5 business days and annually thereafter.

2. Account security

- **Multi-factor authentication (MFA)** is required on all company accounts (Google Workspace, Okta, GitHub, AWS, Slack) within 24 hours of account creation. Accounts without MFA enabled after 48 hours are automatically suspended pending remediation with IT.
- Passwords must be at least **14 characters**, unique to Meridian Labs systems, and stored only in the company-approved password manager (1Password). Password reuse across personal and work accounts is prohibited.
- Shared accounts/credentials are not permitted except for designated service accounts approved by Security.

3. Device security

- Company laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled (FileVault for Mac, BitLocker for Windows) — this is enforced automatically via mobile device management (MDM) and cannot be disabled.
- Screens must auto-lock after **5 minutes** of inactivity.
- Security patches and OS updates pushed via MDM must be installed within **72 hours** of release.
- Personal devices (BYOD) may access email and Slack via approved mobile apps only, with MDM enrollment required. Personal devices may not be used to access source code repositories or customer data systems.

4. Data classification

Classification	Examples	Handling requirement
Public	Marketing materials, public docs	No special handling
Internal	Internal wikis, roadmaps, org charts	Meridian Labs employees only; not for external sharing
Confidential	Customer data, financial data, source code	Access on a need-to-know basis; encrypted in transit and at rest

Classification	Examples	Handling requirement
Restricted	Customer PII, security credentials, legal/HR records	Access logged and reviewed quarterly; least-privilege access only

5. Acceptable use

Company systems are provided for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use (e.g., checking personal email) is permitted provided it does not interfere with work, consume significant resources, or violate any other section of this policy. Prohibited uses include:

- Installing unapproved software or browser extensions on company devices without IT review.
- Storing company data in personal cloud storage (personal Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud, etc.).
- Sharing credentials, API keys, or access tokens outside of the approved secrets manager (Vault).
- Connecting to company systems over public Wi-Fi without the company VPN enabled.
- Using generative AI tools with customer data or source code unless the tool has been reviewed and approved by Security (see the approved AI tools list on the intranet).

6. Phishing and social engineering

Meridian Labs runs periodic simulated phishing tests. Employees who click a simulated phishing link are required to complete a short refresher training; this is not punitive and is not recorded in performance reviews. Employees who suspect a real phishing attempt should forward the email to and not click any links or reply.

7. Incident reporting

Any suspected security incident — a lost or stolen device, a suspicious login alert, an accidental data exposure, or a successful phishing compromise — must be reported to **immediately** and no later than 1 hour after discovery. There is no penalty for reporting in good faith, even if the incident resulted from a mistake; delayed reporting is treated more seriously than the underlying incident.

8. Third-party tools and vendors

New software tools that will touch company or customer data require Security review before purchase or adoption, submitted via the #security-review Slack channel. This includes free tools and browser extensions, not just paid vendor contracts.

9. Offboarding and access revocation

Upon an employee's last day, IT revokes all system access within **1 hour** of the termination being processed in BambooHR. Employees must return all company devices within 10 business days (see Equipment Policy) and delete any company data from personal devices or accounts, confirmed via a signed offboarding checklist.

10. Consequences of violations

Violations of this policy are handled under the Workplace Conduct Code. Minor, first-time, non-malicious violations (e.g., a missed patch window) typically result in a reminder from IT. Deliberate violations (e.g., exfiltrating customer data, sharing credentials) may result in immediate termination and, where applicable, referral to law enforcement.

Benefits Overview

Document owner: People Operations (Benefits) **Last updated:** January 2026 **Applies to:** Regular full-time employees (30+ hours/week) and, where noted, part-time employees at 20+ hours/week

1. Health insurance

Meridian Labs offers three medical plan options through Anthem Blue Cross, administered via the Gusto benefits platform:

Plan	Monthly premium (employee only)	Company contribution	Deductible (individual)
PPO Base	\$180	85%	\$1,500
PPO Plus	\$260	80%	\$750
HDHP + HSA	\$90	90%	\$3,000 (HSA-eligible)

Dependent and family coverage is available on all three plans; the company contributes 70% of the premium for dependents (compared to 80–90% for employee-only coverage).

Employees on the HDHP plan receive an annual company HSA contribution of **\$750 (individual)** or **\$1,500 (family)**, deposited in two installments (January and July).

2. Dental and vision

Dental (Delta Dental) and vision (VSP) coverage are each available for **\$15/month** (employee only, company pays the remainder) with standard preventive, basic, and major service tiers. Orthodontia is covered at 50% up to a \$1,500 lifetime maximum under the dental plan.

3. Enrollment windows

- **New hire enrollment:** within 30 days of your start date; coverage begins the first of the month following your start date.
- **Open enrollment:** held every November for coverage effective the following January 1.
- **Qualifying life events** (marriage, birth/adoption, loss of other coverage, etc.) open a 30-day special enrollment window outside the normal cycle.

4. Retirement — 401(k)

Meridian Labs offers a 401(k) plan through Fidelity with:

- Immediate eligibility (no waiting period).
- A company match of **100% of the first 4%** of employee contributions (dollar-for-dollar up to 4% of salary).

- A vesting schedule of 25% per year over 4 years for the match (employee contributions are always 100% vested).
- Both traditional (pre-tax) and Roth (post-tax) contribution options.

5. Life and disability insurance

- **Basic life insurance:** 1x annual salary, fully company-paid, up to a \$500,000 cap.
- **Supplemental life insurance:** employees may purchase additional coverage up to 5x salary at group rates, guaranteed issue up to \$200,000 without a medical exam.
- **Short-term disability:** company-paid, covers 60% of salary for up to 12 weeks.
- **Long-term disability:** company-paid, covers 60% of salary after a 90-day elimination period.

6. Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

All employees and their household members have access to a confidential EAP (via Lyra Health) offering up to **8 free counseling sessions per issue per year**, plus legal and financial consultation services. Usage is confidential and not reported to the company in any identifiable form.

7. Wellness stipend

Employees receive a **\$50/month wellness stipend**, expensable through Ramp, for gym memberships, fitness classes, or wellness apps.

8. Parental leave

See the Leave of Absence Policy for full parental leave details (16 weeks paid for birthing parents, 10 weeks paid for non-birthing parents/adoptive parents).

9. Commuter benefits

Employees in hub cities (Portland, Austin, Raleigh) may set aside up to the IRS pre-tax limit per month for transit or parking costs via a commuter benefits card.

10. Perks

- \$100/month professional development budget in addition to the \$500/year books/training allowance noted in the Expense Reimbursement Policy.
- Company laptop and equipment (see Equipment Policy).
- Annual company all-hands event with travel covered.

11. Questions

Contact or schedule time via the benefits calendar link on the intranet.

Compensation and Payroll Basics

Document owner: Finance & People Operations **Last updated:** January 2026

1. Pay schedule

Meridian Labs pays employees **semi-monthly**, on the **15th and last day of the month**. If a pay date falls on a weekend or bank holiday, pay is issued on the preceding business day. Direct deposit is set up during onboarding through Gusto; paper checks are not issued except in the case of a documented banking issue.

2. Pay stub access

Pay stubs are available in Gusto under “Pay History,” typically posted the morning of each pay date. Employees can update tax withholding elections (W-4) and direct deposit information at any time through Gusto without needing to contact Payroll directly.

3. Overtime (non-exempt employees)

Non-exempt employees are paid **1.5x their regular hourly rate** for hours worked beyond 40 in a single workweek (Sunday-Saturday). Overtime must be pre-approved by a manager where reasonably possible, but worked overtime is always paid regardless of prior approval — lack of approval may instead result in a coaching conversation with the employee’s manager. Non-exempt employees must record all hours worked, including any work performed outside scheduled hours (e.g., checking email at night), in the time-tracking system (Rippling Time).

4. Salary structure and pay bands

Each role at Meridian Labs is assigned to a level (e.g., IC2, IC3, M1) and a corresponding pay band based on market benchmarking, reviewed annually. Pay bands are not published company-wide but are shared with an employee for their specific role upon request to their manager or People Operations. Compensation decisions consider the pay band, internal equity, and individual performance and experience.

5. Annual compensation review

Compensation is formally reviewed once per year, typically in March, alongside the annual performance review cycle. Adjustments (if any) take effect on the April 1 pay period. Off-cycle adjustments (e.g., for a promotion or market correction) can occur at any time with manager and VP approval.

6. Bonuses

Eligible roles may participate in an annual bonus plan, target amounts specified in the offer letter as a percentage of base salary. Bonus payouts, if any, are based on both company performance against annual goals and individual performance, and

are paid out in the March payroll cycle following the performance year. Bonuses are discretionary and not guaranteed regardless of target percentage stated.

7. Equity

Employees granted equity (stock options or RSUs) receive grant details in a separate agreement through Carta. Standard vesting is **4 years with a 1-year cliff** — 25% vests on the first anniversary of the grant date, with the remainder vesting monthly or quarterly thereafter, depending on grant type. Equity questions should be directed to , not general Payroll.

8. Referral bonuses

Employees who refer a candidate who is hired receive a **\$2,500 referral bonus** for most roles, or **\$5,000** for referrals into hard-to-fill engineering or leadership roles (as designated by Talent Acquisition at the time the role is posted). The bonus is paid after the referred employee completes 90 days of employment, via a separate payroll line item.

9. Deductions from pay

Standard deductions include federal/state/local taxes, benefits premiums, and 401(k) contributions. Deductions for equipment loss/damage (see Equipment Policy) or unreturned property will only be made from final pay to the extent permitted by applicable state law; several states prohibit such deductions entirely, in which case Meridian Labs will instead pursue reimbursement through a separate invoice.

10. Pay discrepancies

If you believe there's an error in your pay, contact immediately. Corrections identified before the next pay run are corrected in that run; corrections identified after are issued as an off-cycle payment within 3 business days of confirmation, consistent with applicable state pay-timing requirements.

11. Final pay upon separation

Final pay, including any legally required payout of accrued, unused PTO (see PTO Policy for which states require this), is issued according to state law timing requirements — in most states this is the next regular payroll date, but several states (e.g., California) require final pay on the last day of employment for involuntary terminations. People Operations coordinates the exact timing with Payroll based on the employee's work state.

12. Questions

Contact for pay and deduction questions, or for compensation band, bonus, or equity questions.

Equipment Policy

Document owner: IT **Last updated:** February 2026

1. Standard issue equipment

New employees choose between the following standard configurations at the time of hire:

Item	Option A	Option B
Laptop	MacBook Pro 14" (M-series, 16GB RAM)	Dell XPS 15 (Intel, 16GB RAM)
Monitor (in-office/hybrid)	One 27" 4K monitor	One 27" 4K monitor
Peripherals	Keyboard, mouse, webcam, headset	Keyboard, mouse, webcam, headset

Engineering roles requiring higher specifications (e.g., 32GB+ RAM, discrete GPU) can request an upgraded configuration via a ticket to , subject to manager approval.

2. Shipping and setup

Remote and hybrid employees receive equipment shipped to their home address 5-7 business days before their start date. In-office employees pick up equipment from the front desk on day one. All equipment is pre-configured with MDM enrollment, required security software, and standard applications before shipping.

3. Replacement cycle

- Laptops are refreshed every **3 years**, or sooner if a hardware failure cannot be economically repaired.
- Monitors and peripherals are refreshed every **5 years** or upon failure.
- Employees may request an off-cycle replacement through ; approval depends on documented performance issues or damage.

4. Loss, theft, or damage

- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to and **immediately** so the device can be remotely locked and wiped.
- Accidental damage (e.g., a cracked screen) is covered by the company's device insurance for the first incident per employee per rolling 12-month period. A second incident within that window may result in a \$100 deductible charged via payroll deduction, unless the damage was clearly not the result of employee negligence.
- Devices lost due to gross negligence (e.g., left unattended and unlocked in a public place, resulting in theft) may result in the full replacement cost being charged to the employee, at manager and IT discretion.

5. Personal use

Company laptops are intended primarily for business use but may be used for incidental personal tasks (e.g., personal email) consistent with the Data Security and Acceptable Use Policy. Company equipment should not be used to store significant amounts of personal data, as it may not survive a required re-image or remote wipe.

6. BYOD (Bring Your Own Device)

Employees may use personal devices for email, calendar, and Slack via approved mobile apps after MDM enrollment (see Data Security Policy, Section 3). Personal devices may not be used to access source code repositories, production systems, or customer data.

7. Return of equipment

All company-issued equipment must be returned within **10 business days** of separation from the company:

- In-office/hybrid employees return equipment in person to the front desk or their manager.
- Remote employees receive a prepaid return shipping label via email within 1 business day of their last day.

Equipment not returned within 30 days of separation may be treated as unreturned company property, and the replacement cost may be deducted from final pay to the extent permitted by applicable state law, or billed directly.

8. Software and licenses

All software installed on company devices must be approved by IT. Employees needing a new tool should submit a request via ; approval typically takes 2-3 business days and includes a security review per the Data Security Policy.

9. Questions

Contact or the #it-help Slack channel for equipment requests, issues, or returns.

Leave of Absence Policy

Document owner: People Operations **Last updated:** March 2026 **Note:** This policy provides company benefits that meet or exceed the minimums required under federal law (including the Family and Medical Leave Act, FMLA) and applicable state laws. Where state law provides greater benefits than described here, the state law entitlement applies.

1. Parental leave

Meridian Labs provides paid parental leave for the birth, adoption, or fostering of a child, available to employees who have completed at least 90 days of employment as of the leave start date:

Parent type	Paid leave duration
Birthing parent	16 weeks
Non-birthing parent / adoptive / foster parent	10 weeks

Leave must generally be taken within 12 months of the birth/placement and can be taken continuously or, with manager approval, in two blocks. Parental leave runs concurrently with FMLA leave where the employee is FMLA-eligible (12 months of employment and 1,250 hours worked in the prior 12 months) and with any applicable state family leave program (e.g., Oregon Paid Leave, California PFL); the company tops up state benefit payments to reach 100% of regular pay for the duration listed above.

2. Medical leave

Employees with a serious health condition preventing them from working may take **up to 12 weeks** of job-protected leave per rolling 12-month period under FMLA (for eligible employees) or a company-provided equivalent for employees not yet FMLA-eligible, subject to manager and People Operations approval. Medical leave is unpaid unless the employee elects to use accrued PTO or short-term disability benefits (see Benefits Overview) to cover some or all of the leave period. Certification from a healthcare provider is required within 15 days of the leave request.

3. Bereavement leave

Employees receive:

- **5 paid days** for the death of an immediate family member (spouse/partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, or the equivalent in-law).
- **2 paid days** for the death of an extended family member or close friend, at manager discretion.

Additional unpaid time or use of accrued PTO can be arranged with manager approval.

4. Jury duty and court appearances

Meridian Labs provides paid leave for jury duty service and legally required court appearances (e.g., as a witness under subpoena) for the full duration of the service, with proof of summons/subpoena provided to . Any jury duty stipend received from the court may be kept by the employee in addition to regular pay.

5. Military leave

Employees called to active duty, reserve training, or National Guard service are provided leave in accordance with the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (USERRA), including job protection and reinstatement rights. Meridian Labs pays the difference between military pay and the employee's regular salary for up to **15 days per year** of leave for military training or short-term active duty.

6. Voting leave

Employees are provided up to **2 hours of paid time** to vote in any public election if their work schedule does not otherwise provide sufficient time, consistent with applicable state law (some states provide more; the more generous state requirement applies).

7. Domestic violence and safe leave

Where required by state law, employees may take job-protected leave to address domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking, including time to seek medical attention, counseling, or legal assistance. Contact confidentially to arrange this leave; documentation requirements follow the applicable state law.

8. Requesting leave

1. Notify your manager and as soon as reasonably possible — at least 30 days in advance for foreseeable leave (e.g., a planned birth), or as soon as practicable for unforeseeable leave.
2. People Operations will confirm eligibility, required documentation, and how the leave interacts with PTO, short-term disability, and any state paid leave programs.
3. Employees on approved leave continue to receive employer-sponsored health benefits under the same terms as if actively working, for the duration of FMLA-qualifying leave (up to 12 weeks).

9. Return to work

Employees returning from leave are reinstated to the same or an equivalent position with the same pay, benefits, and seniority, consistent with FMLA and applicable state law. A return-to-work conversation with your manager and People Operations is scheduled before your return date to plan re-onboarding.

10. Questions

Contact for any leave request or question; all leave discussions are handled confidentially.

Workplace Conduct Code

Document owner: People Operations & Legal **Last updated:** April 2026 **Applies to:** All employees, contractors, interns, and members of the Board of Directors

1. Purpose

This Code sets expectations for professional conduct at Meridian Labs. It applies in the office, while working remotely, at company events, and in any setting where you represent Meridian Labs, including company-branded social media and industry events.

2. Anti-harassment and anti-discrimination

Meridian Labs prohibits harassment or discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, marital status, veteran status, genetic information, or any other status protected by applicable law. This includes:

- Unwelcome verbal, physical, or visual conduct that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.
- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome advances, requests for favors, and offensive jokes or comments.
- Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation.

All managers are required to complete anti-harassment training annually; all employees complete it within their first 5 business days and annually thereafter.

3. Reporting a concern

Employees can report a concern about harassment, discrimination, retaliation, or any other conduct issue through any of the following channels:

- Directly to your manager
-
- The anonymous ethics line: 1-888-555-0199 (available 24/7, operated by a third-party provider, reports can be submitted anonymously)
- Any member of the People Operations or Legal team

Reports are investigated promptly, generally within **10 business days** of receipt, by People Operations or an independent investigator for more serious matters. Confidentiality is maintained to the extent possible consistent with conducting a thorough investigation. Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is itself a serious violation of this policy, independent of the outcome of the underlying investigation.

4. Conflicts of interest

Employees must disclose potential conflicts of interest to their manager and , including:

- Financial interests in a competitor, customer, or vendor.
- Hiring or supervising a family member or someone with whom you have a close personal relationship (requires disclosure and, typically, a reporting-line adjustment).
- Outside employment or board positions that could compete with or interfere with your Meridian Labs role.

Disclosed conflicts are reviewed by People Operations and Legal, who may require specific safeguards (e.g., recusal from certain decisions) rather than prohibiting the activity outright.

5. Confidential information

Employees must protect confidential company and customer information both during and after employment, as further detailed in the Data Security Policy and any signed confidentiality agreement. This includes not discussing unreleased product plans, financial results, or customer information outside the company, including on social media or with friends and family.

6. Social media

Employees may identify themselves as Meridian Labs employees on personal social media but should:

- Make clear that views expressed are their own, not the company's.
- Not share confidential, non-public information (including screenshots of internal tools or Slack).
- Follow the same anti-harassment standards as in the physical or virtual workplace when interacting with colleagues online, even outside work hours.

7. Drug and alcohol policy

Employees must not be impaired by alcohol or non-prescribed drugs during work hours or while operating company equipment. Alcohol may be served in moderation at approved company events; employees are expected to drink responsibly and are never required to consume alcohol at any company function.

8. Workplace violence

Meridian Labs has zero tolerance for threats or acts of violence, including verbal threats, intimidation, or possession of weapons on company property or at company events. Any concern should be reported immediately to and, if there is an immediate safety risk, to local emergency services (911) first.

9. Disciplinary process

Violations of this Code may result in disciplinary action, which is generally progressive but may skip steps depending on severity:

1. Verbal coaching, documented in a written summary
2. Formal written warning
3. Final written warning / performance improvement plan
4. Termination

Serious violations — including harassment, discrimination, workplace violence, theft, or falsification of records — may result in immediate termination without progressing through earlier steps.

10. Non-retaliation commitment

No employee will face adverse action for reporting a good-faith concern under this Code, refusing to participate in illegal activity, or cooperating with an internal or external investigation. Employees who believe they have experienced retaliation should report it through any of the channels in Section 3.

11. Questions

Direct questions about this Code to or .

Business Travel and Safety Guidelines

Document owner: Finance & Security **Last updated:** February 2026

1. When this applies

This document covers safety and logistics guidance for company-approved business travel, including customer visits, conferences, team offsites, and the annual all-hands. It supplements, and should be read alongside, the Expense Reimbursement Policy for cost rules and the Data Security Policy for device and data-handling requirements while traveling.

2. Booking travel

Flights and hotels for approved trips should be booked through the company travel portal (Navan) whenever possible, which provides negotiated rates and automatic duty-of-care tracking (so the company knows where traveling employees are in case of an emergency, such as a natural disaster or civil unrest at the destination). Booking outside Navan is permitted for cost or scheduling reasons but must still be logged in Navan's "manual trip" feature within 24 hours so the company can track traveler safety.

3. Approval thresholds

- Domestic trips under \$1,500 total cost: manager approval only.
- Domestic trips over \$1,500, or any international trip: manager and VP approval, requested at least 2 weeks (domestic) or 3 weeks (international) in advance.
- Trips to a Level 3 or Level 4 US State Department travel advisory country require additional Security and Legal sign-off and are approved only in exceptional, business-critical circumstances.

4. Device security while traveling

- Enable the company VPN before connecting to any hotel, airport, or conference Wi-Fi.
- Do not leave laptops or phones unattended in public spaces, including at conference booths or hotel gyms.
- For international travel to higher-risk destinations (as flagged by Security based on the State Department advisory level), employees may be issued a loaner "travel laptop" with minimal data instead of their primary device — check with at least 2 weeks before departure.
- Report a lost or stolen device while traveling immediately to , even outside normal business hours; the security on-call rotation monitors this inbox 24/7.

5. Personal safety

- Register international trips with the State Department's STEP program (Smart Traveler Enrollment Program) for additional safety alerts; this is optional but encouraged and does not need to be reported to the company.
- Employees who feel unsafe at any point during business travel (including at a conference, client site, or team event) should contact their manager or immediately; the company will cover the cost of changing travel plans to ensure safety, no questions asked and without needing pre-approval in an emergency.
- Meridian Labs maintains a 24/7 travel emergency assistance line (via our travel insurance provider, included automatically with any Navan-booked trip) for medical emergencies, evacuation assistance, or lost documents while traveling; the number is provided in the Navan trip confirmation email.

6. Ground transportation and rideshare

Rideshare and taxi expenses are reimbursable per the Expense Reimbursement Policy. Employees are encouraged to use rideshare or hotel transportation rather than walking alone late at night in an unfamiliar city, particularly when traveling solo.

7. Team offsites and events

Quarterly team offsites and the annual all-hands are organized centrally with a designated event lead who serves as the point of contact for logistics and any on-site issues. Alcohol may be served at evening social events; employees are never required to drink and non-alcoholic options are always provided, consistent with the Workplace Conduct Code's drug and alcohol guidance.

8. Travel involving family members

Employees may extend a business trip for personal travel (e.g., staying an extra weekend) at their own expense; the company will only cover costs for the business portion of the trip, and any cost comparison needed to isolate business-only pricing should be documented and attached to the expense report.

9. Questions

Contact for booking/logistics questions, or for safety concerns or device security questions while traveling.

Quick Reference: Who To Contact

Document owner: People Operations — **Last updated:** March 2026

This page collects the most commonly requested contacts and escalation paths in one place. It summarizes, but does not replace, the full policy documents referenced.

General questions

Topic	Contact	Response
Payroll questions (pay date, deductions, direct deposit)		2 bus
Benefits enrollment or changes		2 bus
PTO / holiday balance questions		2 bus
Equipment requests, replacements, or issues	 / #it-help	1 bus
New software or tool approval		2-3 b
Expense report questions	 / #finance-help	2 bus

Urgent / time-sensitive

Situation	Contact	Response
Lost or stolen company device	 and 	Immedi
Suspected phishing email or security incident		Within 1
Workplace safety threat	911 first, then 	Immedi

Confidential / sensitive

Situation	Contact
Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation concern	 or the anonym
Leave of absence request (parental, medical, bereavement, etc.)	
Conflict of interest disclosure	 and your man

Related policy documents

- PTO Policy
- Holiday Schedule
- Remote and Hybrid Work Policy
- Expense Reimbursement Policy
- Data Security and Acceptable Use Policy
- Benefits Overview
- Equipment Policy
- Leave of Absence Policy
- Workplace Conduct Code

MERIDIAN LABS — NEW HIRE FAQ (plain text quick answers)

Document owner: People Operations Last updated: February 2026

This file collects short answers to the questions new hires ask most often. Full detail lives in the linked policy documents; this file is a quick-start summary only.

Q: When do my benefits start? A: The first day of the month after your start date. You must actively enroll within 30 days of your start date in BambooHR/Gusto — coverage does not start automatically. See Benefits Overview.

Q: How much PTO do I get? A: 15 days/year for 0-2 years of tenure, 20 days/year for 3-5 years, 25 days/year for 6+ years, accruing per pay period. Directors and above are on unlimited discretionary PTO. See PTO Policy.

Q: How many paid holidays are there? A: 11 fixed holidays plus a paid winter shutdown (Dec 26-31) plus 2 floating holidays per year. See Holiday Schedule.

Q: Do I have to come into the office? A: Depends on your work location category set at hire: Remote (no requirement), Hybrid (2 days/week, usually Tue/Thu), or In-office (4-5 days/week). See Remote and Hybrid Work Policy.

Q: How do I get reimbursed for a work expense? A: Submit it in Ramp within 30 days with a receipt for anything over \$25. Manager approval is required for expenses up to \$1,000; VP approval is also required above that. See Expense Reimbursement Policy.

Q: Do I need to set up two-factor authentication? A: Yes, on all company accounts, within 24 hours of account creation. Accounts are suspended after 48 hours without it. See Data Security Policy.

Q: What laptop do I get? A: Choice of a MacBook Pro 14" or a Dell XPS 15, both with 16GB RAM standard (higher specs available for engineering roles with manager approval). Laptops are refreshed every 3 years. See Equipment Policy.

Q: How much parental leave do I get? A: 16 weeks paid for birthing parents, 10 weeks paid for non-birthing/adoptive/foster parents, after 90 days of employment. See Leave of Absence Policy.

Q: What is the 401(k) match? A: 100% match on the first 4% of your contributions, vesting 25% per year over 4 years. No waiting period to start contributing. See Benefits Overview.

Q: Who do I talk to if I have a concern about a coworker's behavior? A: Your manager, , or the anonymous ethics line at 1-888-555-0199. Retaliation for good-faith reports is itself a policy violation. See Workplace Conduct Code.

Q: What happens to my unused PTO at the end of the year? A: You can carry over up to 5 days (40 hours) into the new year; anything above that is forfeited, except in states where forfeiture is not legally allowed. See PTO Policy.

Q: Who do I contact for IT problems? A: or the #it-help Slack channel.